

In recalibration mode

This edition of the T20 World Cup will be fittingly co-hosted by India, a team carrying ample imprints of the **paradigm shift** that the sport's youngest format has embraced of late.

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After India clinched the 2024 T20 World Cup, Suryakumar Yadav has overseen a seamless transition — not only of its ranks but of pursuit as well. Since June 30, 2024, India has held a win rate of 75 per cent — the highest for a Full-Member nation. Australia is a close second at 70 per cent.

This success is built largely on defining a template. India abandoned its approach of stocking its resources for a final surge at the death, instead opting for an immediate, all-in, relentless pursuit of the leather that has sent run rates bursting through the roof.

India has scored at 10.34 runs an over in PowerPlays in 2025, the fastest it has batted in the phase. India still attacked in the death overs, but the gulf in intent between the first six overs and the death overs has shrunk significantly. For instance, in 2007, when it first won the World Cup, India's run rate in the PowerPlay was 8.25, compared to 10.73 at the death.

However, the defending champion is not the only one pivoting to this rebranded take on the game.

The approach is mirrored in how Australia (9.77), England (10.18) and New Zealand (9.80) have thrust impetus up front, all scoring at nearly 10 an over in the first six overs, setting the stage for flamboyant opening batters like Phil Salt, Travis Head and Abhishek Sharma.

On relatively flatter strips and smaller ground dimensions, this approach will permeate into the World Cup as well.

The necessity to pocket quick runs has prompted batters to revise their playbooks and search for novel

Slow way to go: In

T20Is in 2025, the off-cutter was used more than 1,600 times by pacers. Jasprit Bumrah, one of the quickest in the game, has been its most frugal proponent. PTI

